



ESBM 3700 ENTREPRENEURIAL ENVIRONMENTS

LECTURE 1 INTRODUCTION



University of Colorado **Boulder**

Welcome

- Great to have you in ESBM 3700!
- In this course, we aim to explore the journey of an entrepreneur.
- You DO NOT have to plan to become an entrepreneur to benefit from this course!
- This course will offer an intro to entrepreneurship through presentations, class discussions, teamwork, movies, entrepreneur guest lectures, and many more!

About me

Sina Khosh Sokhan

Assistant Professor of Strategy and Entrepreneurship

My research interests include *innovation*,
intellectual property rights, and *entrepreneurship*

Born and raised in Iran

Received my PhD from Boston University

Have an MBA and an undergrad degree in
Mechanical Engineering



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Sarvenaz Hashemiborzabadi
Doctoral Student in Strategy and Entrepreneurship

With exciting research on AI in pharmaceuticals



My teaching philosophy

- Instead of an instructor, I prefer to consider myself a guide.
- Ideally, this course will be a “**guided discovery**”.
 - So, it requires **active** participation in class conversations.
- I will do my best to make this class a safe space for conversation.
 - It would be great to be in “intellectually uncomfortable” situations.
That’s exactly where a lot of innovations come from!

Why Entrepreneurial Environments?

- What is entrepreneurship?
- Why entrepreneurship?
- Is learning about entrepreneurship only useful for founding and managing a startup?
- What elements of entrepreneurship could be learned?
- ...

Course structure

Module 1

Entrepreneurial Mindset

Ideas to Opportunities

Business Models

Sources of Funding

Lean Startup

Lean Startup Exercise

Venture Pitching

Module 2

Choosing Your Customer

Choosing Your Technology

Choosing Your Identity

Choosing Your Competition

Quiz

Module 3

Disruption Strategy

Intellectual Property Strategy

Value Chain Strategy

Architectural Strategy

Bonus: Startup Failure

Bonus: Shark Tank

Final Exam

Evaluation criteria

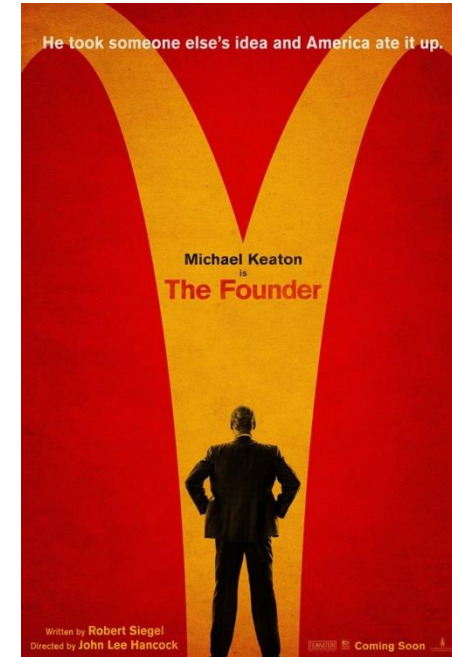
Item	Weight
Class Participation	15%
Reading Assignments & Film Critiques	20%
Quiz	15%
Website Design	10%
Final Presentation	20%
Final Exam	20%
Total	100%

Evaluation criteria: Reading assignments

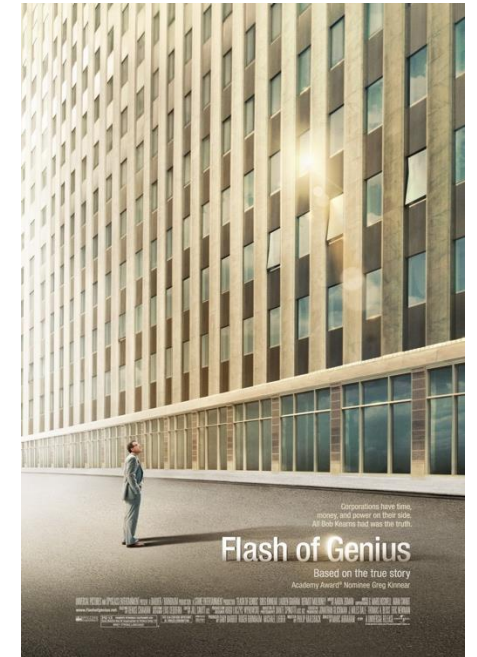
- **Individual** assignments that you will complete on Canvas
- Each comprises multiple-choice questions from the topics discussed in the proceeding lecture
- Be sure to complete them before the class begins, as that's when they're due!
 - This deadline is selected to give you as much time as possible before the beginning of the class. You should, however, submit your assignments well in advance.

Evaluation criteria: Film critiques

- Watch these two movies.
- We will have two multiple-choice assignments based on these movies.



**The Founder
(2016)**



**Flash of Genius
(2008)**

Evaluation criteria: Quizzes and the Final Exam

- We will have one quiz on Oct. 14 and a final exam at the end of the course.
- They are designed to assess the depth of your understanding of the class topics.
- The focus is on lectures, not cases, entrepreneur guests, or movies.
- You will take the quizzes at home.
- Make sure you have Proctorio installed. Otherwise, you cannot take the test.
- Please submit your ADA requests as soon as possible. I'll be happy to accommodate.

Evaluation criteria: Class participation

- Active participation in class conversations is key.
- We use iClicker to keep attendance. Make sure it is up and running!
 - If you encounter any issues with your iClicker, please email me immediately after class.
- Stellar participation may lead to grade bumps.

iClicker

- You are tasked with suggesting a TV show to the class. What is your top pick?
 - A) Bear
 - B) Succession
 - C) The Sopranos
 - D) The Last of US
 - E) Other suggestions?

ChatGPT and other AI tools

- What should the class policy be?

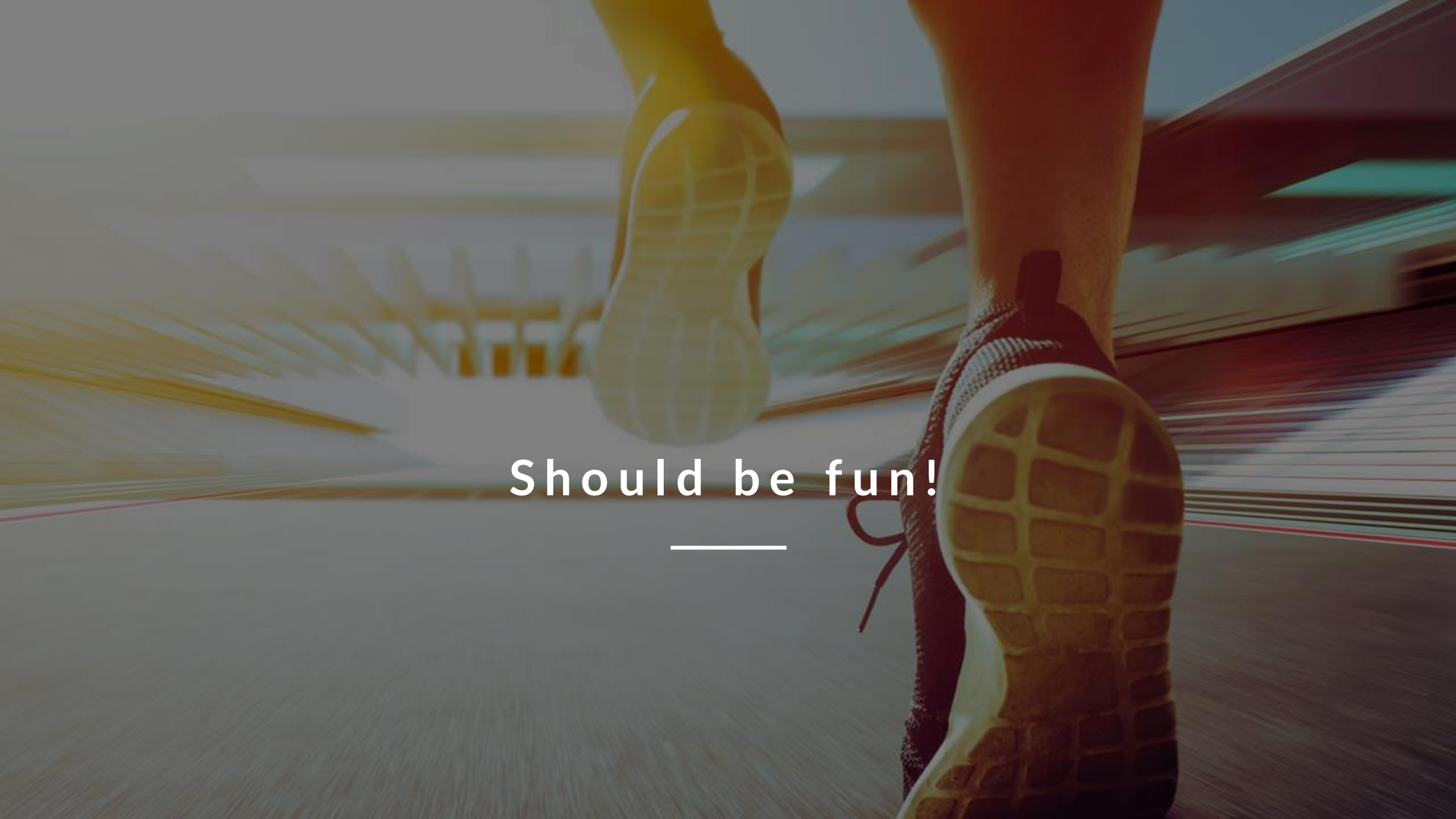
Evaluation criteria: Website design

- During the semester, we will build a website for our team's entrepreneurial idea.
- The website will be evaluated based on:
 - Clarity of Purpose
 - User Experience
 - Design and Branding
 - Content Quality
 - Innovation and Creativity
- Team assignments: You will send me your teams by September 21st.
- **A note on group work:** Group work hazards are real. To mitigate them, at the end of the course, I will ask you to evaluate your group members. If there are concerns about a group member's performance, I will go back and deduct points individually.

Evaluation criteria: Final presentation

- During the semester, you need to work on a “hypothetical” entrepreneurial idea and present it, like a venture pitching, at the end of the class.
- You work in teams of 5. You must choose your teams yourselves.
- A group of judges (potential investors) will assess your presentation, from your idea, to your presentation style, to your handling of the questions, and give you your grade.
- As we get closer to the end, it would be helpful to meet with me and get feedback on your project/presentation.

Questions?

A low-angle, close-up shot of a person's legs and feet while running on a track. The runner is wearing dark-colored sneakers with a prominent white sole and a yellowish-tan grid pattern on the bottom. The background is heavily blurred with horizontal streaks of yellow, orange, and blue, suggesting high speed and a bright, sunny environment. The text "Should be fun!" is centered over the image in a white, sans-serif font, with a short horizontal line underneath it.

Should be fun!
